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The future and what it holds

The future of cricket … and of Herschelle Gibbs.

Let’s start with the game and end with me, personally. It’s my book, after all, and having it end with me just seems right. And I do so at the risk of unleashing the traditionalists, who are just waiting to intone: ‘You’re not bigger than the game, boy! *No one* is bigger than the game!’

Ja, I know that, but, like, it’s my book.

CRICKET

Is it the end of Test cricket?

So what is happening to the game, then? Cricket has certainly changed a great deal with the introduction of 20-over cricket, which has gained massive popularity in a very short space of time. For many fans, 20-over cricket is a better version of the game than Test cricket. It’s like the game itself – and not me – has got bigger than the game. Yet I know that some of those above-mentioned traditionalists do not love the new development at all.

There are a lot of concerns that the new, shorter form of the game could spell the end of Test cricket – or at least see the fiveday game take a back seat to the new pyrotechnics. But I don’t think that will be the case. I reckon there will be a much clearer division between Test and limited-overs cricket, from the players who play each respective format of the game to the fans who watch the games.

In my opinion, if there is going to be a casualty down the line, it’s going to be the 50-over form of the game. In the future I think we’re going to see two types of players and two types of fans embracing their favourite format